University of Florida
College of Public Health & Health Professions Syllabus

PHC 6601: Professional Series (ProSeries) in Public Health (0-1 credit)

Semester: Spring 2026
Delivery Format: Online & On-campus
Location: HPNP Room G-101 and/or E-Learning in Canvas

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Office Hours: Eastern Time – Tuesday/Wednesday by appointment
Preferred Course Communications: Email

Prerequisites

Student must be preparing to enter the Applied Practice Experience (PHC 6941) the following semester.

PURPOSE AND OUTCOME

Course Overview

The Professional Series (ProSeries) is a required MPH course that prepares students for the Applied Practice Experience and Capstone while building career readiness. Through seminars, career chats, and applied assignments, students develop professional, technical, and CEPH-aligned competencies for successful entry into the public health workforce.

Relation to Program Outcomes

Students will acquire competencies outlined by Council on Education for Public Health (CEPH, 2024, Section D2) and the MPH program's concentration competencies through Capstone and Applied Practice Experience activities, applying theoretical knowledge to real-world scenarios. This supports competency development in specific public health areas. Interacting professionally with faculty, staff, and peers fosters communication and collaboration skills essential in public health practice. Establishing connections within the public health industry enhances career growth and opportunities for Applied Practice Experience and future employment, aligning with preparing students for professional roles in public health through networking and industry engagement.

Course Objectives and/or Goals

Upon completion of this course, students will be able to:

1. Demonstrate the competencies outlined by the CEPH (2024, Section D2) and the MPH concentration competencies with activities performed during the completion of Applied Practice Experience and Capstone.
2. Interact professionally with faculty, staff, and peers in a variety of formal and informal settings.
3. Prepare to complete an Applied Practice Experience per the requirements of the MPH program and CEPH (2024, Section D5).
4. Prepare to complete a Capstone Project (i.e., integrated learning experience) undertaken in the final semester of the MPH program (CEPH, 2024, Section D7).
5. Deliver a professional oral or poster presentation, as assessed during the Capstone semester.
6. Build professional networks and establish connections within the industry to expand opportunities for both the Applied Practice Experience and future career growth.
7. Practice self-reflection on personal and professional development, identifying areas for improvement and setting goals for future career advancement.

Registration for 0-credit

Students will enroll in PHC 6601 (0-credit) during the semester prior to beginning the Applied Practice Experience (PHC 6941) and again, if applicable, during the semester prior to beginning the MPH Capstone (PHC 6940).
The 0-credit version of PHC 6601 is a mandatory preparatory course that allows students to complete required seminars, modules, and planning assignments before beginning APE and/or Capstone.

- Some students will enroll in PHC 6601 (0-credit) twice, completing the APE preparation track and the Capstone preparation track in different semesters.
- Other students will enroll in PHC 6601 (0-credit) once when their plan of study shows that APE and Capstone occur in the same final semester. In this case, the course prepares students for both requirements concurrently.

Students must earn a Satisfactory (S) grade in all required 0-credit ProSeries offerings before progressing to the final credit-bearing course.

Registration for 1-credit

Students will enroll in PHC 6601 (1-credit) during their final semester in the MPH program, alongside registration for the MPH Capstone (PHC 6940).
Enrollment in the 1-credit version of PHC 6601 is contingent upon the successful completion of all required 0-credit ProSeries preparation, including earning a Satisfactory grade in prior offerings.

Blended Learning

What is blended learning and why is it important?
A Blended Learning class uses a mixture of technology and face-to-face instruction to help you maximize your learning. Knowledge content that, as the instructor, I would have traditionally presented during a live class lecture is instead provided online before the live class takes place. This lets me focus my face-to-face teaching on course activities designed to help you strengthen higher order thinking skills such as critical thinking, problem solving, and collaboration. Competency in these skills is critical for today's health professional.

What is expected of you?

You are expected to actively engage in the course throughout the semester. You must come to class prepared by completing all out-of-class assignments. This preparation gives you the knowledge or practice needed to engage in higher levels of learning during the live class sessions. If you are not prepared for the face-to-face sessions, you may struggle to keep pace with the activities occurring in the live sessions, and it is unlikely that you will reach the higher learning goals of the course. Similarly, you are expected to actively participate in the live class. Your participation fosters a rich course experience for you and your peers that facilitates overall mastery of the course objectives.

Attendance and active participation in seminars are required as part of this course. The instructor recognizes that students may have outside responsibilities, including jobs, families, and other coursework. If a student is unable to attend a seminar, they must obtain prior approval to complete an alternative assignment. Alternative assignments are due within 1-week of the original deadline, unless otherwise specified. As this course emphasizes professionalism, timely completion of assignments and clear communication with the instructor regarding any delays are expected.

DESCRIPTION OF COURSE CONTENT

0-Credit Topical Outline/Course Schedule: APE Track

PHC 6601 is offered in a hybrid format, with class sessions alternating between in-person and online delivery based on the course schedule. Some weeks may include several consecutive in-person sessions followed by online sessions.

- Campus-based students are expected to attend in person during designated in-person class sessions.
- Online students are expected to attend live, synchronous online sessions during scheduled class times unless prior approval has been granted to complete an alternative assignment.
- All students should review the course schedule in Canvas regularly to confirm the format and location of each session.

Public Health Experience (PHE) Requirement – Complete 50 hours of public health experience hours prior to enrolling in PHC 6941 (APE). Exceptions apply; refer to the MPH Student Handbook for details.

Week	Webinar	Assignment(s)	Nace Competency	Readings & Resources
0	Introduction to ProSeries	**Familiarize yourself with ProSeries requirements & expectations. *Video** *Instructions:* Explore Canvas course, review syllabus, submit introduction post Peer Support Team*:* Introduce yourself (concentration) and describe your public health interests/goals Prompt: What do you hope to gain professionally from this course?	Career & Self-Development · Communication · Teamwork	• MPH Student Handbook • Video
1	Understanding ProSeries APE	**Assignment: Public Health Competencies** *Instructions:* Write a reflection on 3 key MPH Foundational Competencies for APE preparation Complete the Nace Career Readiness Assessment (Pre-Test).	Career & Self-Development · Critical Thinking	• MPH Foundational & Core Competencies (Canvas) • NACE - National Association of Colleges and Employers
2	Planning for APE	**Assignment: Professional Development Plan** *Instructions:* Complete Part 1 of the Professional Development Plan (use the Assessment results to help).	Career & Self-Development · Professionalism · Technology	• UF MPH APE Website • PDP Template • Career Tracker via Canvas

		*Share one PDP goal and how you'll track it. Reflect on your Nace Assessment Score: What surprised you about your results? Download Career Tracker		
3	Leadership	Leading from Where you Are: Reflection Activity Discussion Board: Describe a situation you took initiative or influenced a positive outcome without being in a leadership role. How can you apply this approach to your APE?	Leadership · Teamwork · Professionalism	• Video/Reading Self-rating on leadership confidence pre/post
4	Career Chat	**Speaker:** TBA Reflection Assignment Prompt: Which NACE skill did the speaker demonstrate most?	Career & Self-Development · Communication	•
5	Resume & Cover Letter Workshop	**Assignment: Edit your Resume** *Instructions:* Upload revised resume to Quinncia, review feedback, submit final analysis. You must reach a certain score to complete this assignment. Discussion Board: What story does your resume tell about you?	Communication · Professionalism · Career & Self-Development	Resources are provided in the ProSeries Canvas Course In-Person Workshop • Peer Feedback Rubric • Nace Communication Outcome
6	Interview Preparation Workshop	**Assignment: Complete a Mock Interview** *Instructions:* Complete mock interview using Quinncia & submit feedback analysis. Complete the reflection assignment and STAR activity worksheet. *Share	Communication · Professionalism · Critical Thinking	Resources are provided in the ProSeries Canvas Course In-Person Workshop

		one STAR response you are proud of. Perfect your elevator pitch!		
7	Career Readiness	**Assignment: Career Readiness Part 2** Nace Midterm Growth Reflection: One action you'll take to improve a low-rated competency • Update PDP Market Analysis	Career & Self-Development · Critical Thinking	NACE - National Association of Colleges and Employers Stepping Blocks - https://ufl.steppingblocks.com/login
8	Public Health Preceptor Panel for APE	**Fall/Spring -In-person/Virtual** Assignment: Identify 3 Agencies you will be reaching out to and why? Prompt: How does this agency's work contribute to equity in public health? Peer Support Team: Questions??	Career & Self-Development · Equity & Inclusion · Critical Thinking	• Mini-Progress Tracker or checklist
9	LinkedIn Workshop	**Assignment: Create or edit your LinkedIn** *Instructions:* Create or refine LinkedIn profile, submit link in discussion, review at least 3 peer LinkedIn accounts and give constructive feedback. * list 3 public health-related keywords to strengthen SEO and employability	Technology · Communication · Career & Self-Development	Resources are provided in the ProSeries Canvas Course In-Person Workshop
10	Networking & Professional Communication	**Assignment: Professional Development** *Instructions:* Create UFL email signature & draft 4 professional emails Discussion: How to maintain professionalism online and in-person	Communication · Professionalism · Leadership	Resources are provided in the ProSeries Canvas Course Professionalism Rubric

11	Career Chat	**Speaker:** TBA Reflection Assignment (Encourage linking each Career Chat to APE goal development)	Career & Self-Development · Communication	
12	APE Proposal Prep	**Assignment: Meet with Preceptor** *Instructions:* Meet with your preceptor and discuss your APE plan. Peer Support Team: What are your concerns?	Teamwork · Communication · Professionalism	• Mini-Progress Tracker or checklist
13	APE Proposal Submission	**APE Proposals are DUE:** *Instructions:* Finalize and submit APE proposal to APE Coordinator	Critical Thinking · Professionalism · Communication	
14	Career Chat	**Speaker:** TBA * Consider alternating Career Chat themes (Leadership, Technology, Health Equity). Reflection Assignment	Career & Self-Development · Communication	
15	Career Readiness	**Assignment: Career Readiness Final** *Nace Post-Assessment and Final Reflection – update PDP* *Leadership Growth:* Describe one way your leadership skills evolved this semester	Career & Self-Development · Critical Thinking · Professionalism	NACE - National Association of Colleges and Employers
16	Exams			
	Additional Resources:			
	Common Reader Discussion – **Only offered in Fall**	**OPTIONAL:** Read the selected public health related book and participate in discussion. Earn Public Health Experience hours!		Assigned Book

		*Note: Common Reader is only available in the fall, but all students can participate for PHE hours.		
	Microsoft Excel Module	**Assignment: Excel Trainings** *Instructions:* Complete at least 3 Excel Trainings from the modules outlined in either ProSeries or Student Success Hub – 3 modules (beginner, intermediate, advanced)	Technology; Critical Thinking; Professionalism	LinkedIn Learning
	Public Health Experience (PHE Hours)	**Using Gator for Good to Track PHE Hours for Impact Report**	Leadership; Teamwork; Equity & Inclusion; Professionalism	

Course Materials and Technology

Text: None Required

Additional Readings: None Required

Additional Technologies:

This course uses use the Canvas CMS.

UF Internet (eduroam) is available at thousands of locations worldwide!

UF students can access eduroam (highspeed WiFi) for free with their GatorLink log-in credentials.
The eduroam network is fast and secure and has more than 10,000 wi-fi hotspots in 106 countries and territories worldwide. Many of these locations are in open spaces and/or large communal rooms, so you can get online while physically distancing and following CDC guidelines in an air-conditioned space. Access is available in rural areas, too!
Here's a link to all the eduroam sites.

Technical Support

For technical support for the materials posted in the course e-Learning site, activities, and assessments, please post in the appropriate discussion, or contact the designated person.
For all other technical support for this class, please contact the UF Computing Help Desk at:
Phone Number: (352) 392-HELP (4357) Option 2
Email: helpdesk@ufl.edu
Webpage with Chat: UF Computing Help Desk

Additional Academic Resources

- Career Connections Center: Reitz Union Suite 1300, 352-392-1601. Career assistance and counseling services.
- Library Support: Various ways to receive assistance with respect to using the libraries or finding resources.
- Teaching Center: Broward Hall, 352-392-2010 or to make an appointment 352- 392-6420. General study skills and tutoring.
- Writing Studio: 2215 Turlington Hall, 352-846-1138. Help brainstorming, formatting, and writing papers.
- Student Complaints On-Campus: Visit the Student Honor Code and Student Conduct Code webpage for more information.

- On-Line Students Complaints: View the Distance Learning Student Complaint Process

ACADEMIC REQUIREMENTS AND GRADING

Assignments

To receive a satisfactory grade for the 0-credit version of PHC 6601, and before being enrolled in the 1-credit version, students must meet the following **requirements:**

- Attend at least 4 career chat seminar sessions during your time in the MPH program
- Attend all required seminar sessions and complete the assignments associated with them
- Complete all modules of Interprofessional Learning in Health (IPLH)

To receive a satisfactory grade for the 1-credit version of PHC 6601, students must meet the following **requirements:**

- Complete all 0-credit assignments as outlined previously
- Completion of Reflection Paper in the final semester
- Attend three Public Health Day presentations by other students and complete assignment
- Complete the MPH Exit Survey

Grading

The course uses the S/U grade format of the University of Florida. To receive a satisfactory grade for the course, students ***MUST*** meet all requirements identified above.

Grading: S/U (Satisfactory or Unsatisfactory Grade)

Letter Grade	I	NG	S-U
Grade Points	0.0	0.0	0.0

More information on UF grading policy may be found at:
https://gradcatalog.ufl.edu/graduate/regulations/#:~:text=The%20only%20passing%20grades%20for,A%2D%20and%20A%2C%20respectively.

Exam Policy

There are no exams

Policy Related to Make Up Exams or Other Late Work

Please note all faculty are bound by the UF policy for excused absences. For information regarding the UF Attendance Policy see the Registrar website for additional details. I encourage you to please reach out to the instructor if circumstances arise where you need to be absent or submit late work. I will try to balance professionalism with compassion so that we can make alternative plans, when necessary, to help you be successful in this course while prioritizing your emotional and physical well-being. If possible, please reach out before missing a class or a quiz or test.

Any requests for make-ups due to technical issues should be accompanied by the ticket number received from eLearning when the problem was reported to them. The ticket number will document the time and date of the problem. Please e-mail your instructor within 24 hours of the technical difficulty if you wish to request a make-up of a Canvas quiz.

It is my intent that all quizzes and tests will be turned in on time (see dates on course schedule). Assessments cannot be made-up except in the case of circumstances that meet the criteria of the University of Florida policy for an excused absence. However, as described above, please reach out if special circumstances occur, and I will work with you as best as possible.

In the event of an absence, inform the instructor as early as possible prior to the class. For all unplanned absences because of accidents or emergency situations, students should contact their instructor as soon as conditions permit. If an absence for one of the above reasons results in missing an exam or quiz, contact the instructor to arrange a make-up exam or quiz, which will typically take place within one week of the due date.

Policy Related to Make Up Exams or Other Work

Late or alternative work must be completed within 1-week of the original deadline, unless otherwise specified.

Course Policy Related to Required Class Attendance

Attendance in seminars and webinars are required as part of this course.

Policy Related to AI Use in This Course

When authorized by the course director, students may use AI technologies in the completion of coursework as long as they cite all such use by naming the technology and how it was employed. Students assume full responsibility for all content, including errors and omissions. Assistive technology authorized as part of an accommodation for a disability is always permitted.

Course instructors may adjust limitations on AI assistive technology use and must communicate any limitations to students sufficiently in advance of the assignment due date. Failure to cite the use of AI assistive technology, or use of the technology disregarding specific course limitations is considered academic misconduct. **The use of AI on assignments, essays/reflection papers, exams, and quizzes when prohibited by course or college instructions is considered cheating** and students are violating the UF Regulations 4.040 Student Honor Code and Student Conduct Code.

It is important to note that many generative AI models (e.g. ChatGPT, ChatSonic, Google Bard etc) place any information that they are provided with into the public domain. When using such tools, you must therefore ensure that they are **never provided with confidential information**. UF AI systems (e.g., Co-Pilot, NaviGator) should never be provided with confidential information. For the avoidance of doubt, the use of such tools is prohibited for generating any confidential communications, including, but not limited to, communications relating to patient records, clients, students and intellectual property. You are also reminded that you should always review the terms and conditions of any third-party software you use (e.g. proof-reading tools) to ensure that any data they are provided with is appropriately protected. Always verify information and sources generated by AI tools. AI has been known to generate false information and to cite non-existent sources. Also, because AI-generated text mines people's intellectual property without appropriate credit, this raises ethical concerns.

It is not acceptable to use generative AI for reflective writing, as by its very nature, the process of reflective writing demands that you actively engage in the writing process. Delegating this to a natural language processing algorithm may produce convincing outputs but does not demonstrate development in your professional practice.

Students are responsible for understanding their dynamic data stewardship responsibilities to minimize personal, college, and university risk.
UF Integrated Risk Management – CHATGPT Privacy, Factual Accuracy and Usage Guidelines

ACADEMIC POLICIES & RESOURCES

Information about University Academic Policies and Resources.

STUDENT EXPECTATIONS, ROLES, AND OPPORTUNITIES FOR INPUT

Expectations Regarding Course Behavior

Students are expected to arrive on time to virtual or in-person sessions and remain throughout the scheduled time. Disruptive behavior will not be tolerated and may result in the student either being 'dismissed' from the zoom room, or a Conduct Code violation. See the Academic Integrity section of this syllabus and the UF Student Conduct & Honor Codes for details: https://sccr.dso.ufl.edu/policies/student-honor-code-student-conduct-code/

Communications Guidelines

Students are expected to communicate with the instructor regarding any questions and concerns with the course content and assignment deadlines. Students are also expected to communicate when outside factors might delay their ability to submit work in a timely fashion.
Please refer to UF's Netiquette Guidelines here: https://teach.ufl.edu/wp-content/uploads/2020/04/NetiquetteGuideforOnlineCourses.docx

PHHP Student Resources

PHHP's UPTurn (Unified Pathways to Support Wellness) program is a *no-cost mental health and wellness program* that is offered year-round to all PHHP students (undergraduate, graduate and professional level) and students (from any college) who are enrolled in PHHP courses. UPTurn advisors support students on their wellness journeys by curating individualized plans (resources and support) to help them manage academic, social, emotional, and health-related stress.

Interested students are paired with an UPTurn advisor, who meets with each student *virtually* (Zoom, Teams, phone) or *in person* (private office/room in HPNP) for a 45-minute consultation, followed by (if desired):

1. Up to 4 follow-up skills-building visits
2. When needed and appropriate, up to 10 psychotherapy sessions after completion of the 4 follow-up skills-building visits

Note: UPTurn is NOT a crisis/emergency resource. Students who are in crisis are strongly encouraged to use UF's existing crisis support resources.

Students can learn more about UPTurn as well as request an appointment.

Any questions regarding UPTurn can be directed to upturn@phhp.ufl.edu or (352) 273-6850.

Inclusive Learning Environment

Public health and health professions are based on the belief in human dignity and on respect for the individual. As we share our personal beliefs inside or outside of the classroom, it is always with the understanding that we value and respect diversity of background, experience, and opinion, where every individual feels valued. We believe in, and promote, openness and tolerance of differences in ethnicity and culture, and we respect differing personal, spiritual,

religious and political values. We further believe that celebrating such diversity enriches the quality of the educational experiences we provide our students and enhances our own personal and professional relationships. We embrace The University of Florida's Non-Discrimination Policy, which reads, "The University shall actively promote equal opportunity policies and practices conforming to laws against discrimination. The University is committed to non-discrimination with respect to race, creed, color, religion, age, disability, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity and expression, marital status, national origin, political opinions or affiliations, genetic information and veteran status as protected under the Vietnam Era Veterans' Readjustment Assistance Act."